

Ecclesiastes 5:2

Be not rash with thy mouth, and let not thine heart be hasty to utter any thing before God: for God is in heaven, and thou upon earth: therefore let thy words be few.

Ecclesiastes 5:1-7

[1] Keep thy foot when thou goest to the house of God, and be more ready to hear, than to give the sacrifice of fools: for they consider not that they do evil.

[2] Be not rash with thy mouth, and let not thine heart be hasty to utter any thing before God: for God is in heaven, and thou upon earth: therefore let thy words be few.

[3] For a dream cometh through the multitude of business; and a fool's voice is known by multitude of words.

[4] When thou vowest a vow unto God, defer not to pay it; for he hath no pleasure in fools: pay that which thou hast vowed.

[5] Better is it that thou shouldest not vow, than that thou shouldest vow and not pay.

[6] Suffer not thy mouth to cause thy flesh to sin; neither say thou before the angel, that it was an error: wherefore should God be angry at thy voice, and destroy the work of thine hands?

[7] For in the multitude of dreams and many words there are also divers vanities: but fear thou God.

- The context is vows to God.

VOW, noun

1. A solemn promise made to God, or by a pagan to his deity.

RASH, adjective

1. Hasty in council or action; precipitate; resolving or entering on a project or measure without due deliberation and caution, and thus encountering unnecessary hazard; applied to persons; as a rash statesman or minister; a rash commander.

2. Uttered or undertaken with too much haste or too little reflection; as rash words; rash measures.

3. Requiring haste; urgent.

4. Quick; sudden; as rash gunpowder.

Deuteronomy 23:21-23

[21] When thou shalt vow a vow unto the LORD thy God, thou shalt not slack to pay it: for the LORD thy God will surely require it of thee; and it would be sin in thee.

[22] But if thou shalt forbear to vow, it shall be no sin in thee.

[23] That which is gone out of thy lips thou shalt keep and perform; even a freewill offering, according as thou hast vowed unto the LORD thy God, which thou hast promised with thy mouth.

- Numbers chapter 30 also includes more details about the conditions of vows.

Proverbs 20:25

It is a snare to the man who devoureth that which is holy, and after vows to make enquiry.

- Changing your mind about or reconsidering a vow after making it is a snare.

Matthew 5:33-37

[33] Again, ye have heard that it hath been said by them of old time, Thou shalt not forswear thyself, but shalt perform unto the Lord thine oaths:

[34] But I say unto you, **Swear not at all**; neither by heaven; for it is God's throne:

[35] Nor by the earth; for it is his footstool: neither by Jerusalem; for it is the city of the great King.

[36] Neither shalt thou swear by thy head, because thou canst not make one hair white or black.

[37] But let your communication be, Yea, yea; Nay, nay: **for whatsoever is more than these cometh of evil.**

FORSWEAR, verb transitive preterit tense forswore; participle passive forsworn. See Swear and Answer.]

1. To reject or renounce upon oath.

2. To deny upon oath.

Like innocence, and as serenely bold as truth, how loudly he forswears thy gold.

FORSWEAR, verb intransitive To swear falsely; to commit perjury.

- Jesus' command is not only to not swear by heaven, earth, or Jerusalem but also to not swear at all. Instead, simply say yes or no.
- Note that the swearing of here pertains to swearing oaths not to swearing as in curse words
 - **Colossians 3:8** "But now ye also put off all these; anger, wrath, malice, blasphemy, filthy communication out of your mouth."

Matthew 12:34-37

[34] O generation of vipers, how can ye, being evil, speak good things? for out of the abundance of the heart the mouth speaketh.

[35] A good man out of the good treasure of the heart bringeth forth good things: and an evil man out of the evil treasure bringeth forth evil things.

[36] But I say unto you, That **every idle word that men shall speak, they shall give account thereof in the day of judgment.**

[37] **For by thy words thou shalt be justified, and by thy words thou shalt be condemned.**

- As you might imagine or have discovered yourself from the bible, the command about not being quick to speak also extends to regular speech, some of which we've covered in previous verse studies (eg. **Pro. 18:21**, **I Sam. 14**, **Mark 6:23**). The above verse is one that was not included in those.
- Jesus makes it very clear that every word spoken matters thus we should all consider very carefully and pray before we say anything.
- Verse 37 also makes a clear connection to salvation
 - **Romans 10:10** - "For with the heart man believeth unto righteousness; and **with the mouth confession is made unto salvation.**"
 - **Acts 8:37** - "And Philip said, If thou believest with all thine heart, thou mayest. And **he** answered and **said**, **I believe that Jesus Christ is the Son of God.**"